Fabio Sales

Design leader and product builder

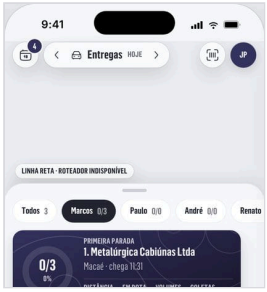
Rio de Janeiro, Brazil
fabio.sales@me.com
fhrsales.github.io/Portfolio
linkedin.com/in/fabiohrsales · github.com/fhrsales

I design complex products and build them. For three decades I have worked across visual design, product, technology, and business: two of them leading art and graphics teams at Estadão, Correio Braziliense, and Diário de Notícias, and now designing and programming the apps a company runs on.

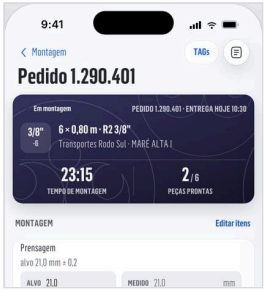

Favela Amazônia, Estadão



Paladar cover, Estadão



Delivery routes, ATBL



Hose assembly, ATBL



Front page, December 6, 2012

EXPERIENCE

ATBL

2025 – present

Transformation and innovation lead, and company administration

- Design and program the apps the company runs on: shipping, the hose workshop, stock and counter sales, all integrated with the Sankhya ERP.
- Shipping moved from paper checking and labels typed in Word to the phone. We estimate dispatch now takes at least half the time; 6,359 deliveries recorded since July 2024, 97% of the confirmed ones with proof of delivery attached.
- 9,269 hoses completed in the workshop app since February 2025; a catalogue of 26,484 active products.
- Help run the company: people management, the reorganization of the sales department, finance, and stock.

Independent

2023 – 2025

Product, technology, and business-process consulting

- Full-stack development, automation, and ERP integration for clients; visual strategy and newsroom training, including Grupo Milenio in Mexico.

Estadão

2005 – 2023

Executive Art Editor

- Led the visual culture of the print and digital editions. Over 18 years at the company, at times coordinated about 75 people: designers, photographers, infographic artists, illustrators, and data journalists.
- Led the 2021 redesign to the Berliner format across editorial, production, and advertising. Five reader surveys backed the decision (89% preferred the new format); the business case estimated a R$7 million increase in EBITDA in 2022.
- Designed and programmed Uva Pages 2.0, the visual-story editor that works directly from a Google Docs document, used for every story published by the multimedia team since 2023. The ai2html and Uva Charts route from Illustrator to responsive graphics was developed by the team under my supervision.
- In 2020 led the Estadão team in a personalized-newsletter experiment with two startups selected by Bradesco's InovaBra program.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

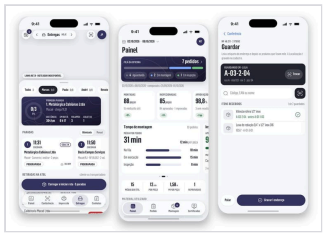
Diário de Notícias, Lisbon	2003 – 2005	Consultant and Art Director. Led a redesign recognized by SND-E as Best Designed Newspaper in Iberia.
Correio Braziliense	2000 – 2003	Art editor, then head of the art department. In 2002 the paper won 36 SND awards, more than in any other year of its history, and was the most awarded Latin American newspaper.
O Dia and O Globo	1997 – 2000	Designer, later deputy art editor.
Consulting and teaching	Throughout	Redesigns and newsroom training in Brazil, Portugal, Mexico, and Peru. Taught at ESPM, São Paulo (2017 – 2019).

SELECTED WORK



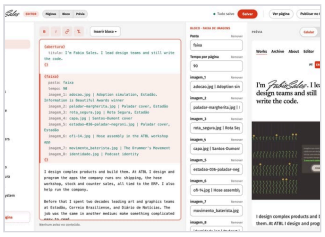
The new Estadão

A daily newspaper redesigned as a system, decided with readers.



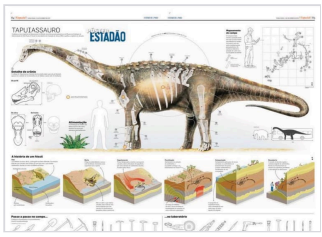
ATBL apps

Shipping, workshop, and stock on the phone, reading from and writing to the ERP.



Uva Pages 2.0 and this site's editor

Tools that let a newsroom publish visual stories without waiting for a developer.



Tapuiassauro

Infographic, Malofiej gold medal in 2011.

RECOGNITION

For work I directed or led with my teams.

- Malofiej: jury member in 2009; gold medal in 2011, among other distinctions
- Society for News Design: awards of excellence and bronze medals, 2005 to 2020
- Prêmio Vladimir Herzog: 2015 and 2016
- Prêmio Esso: finalist in 2010, regional award in 2015
- Inter American Press Association: data journalism award, 2020
- Information is Beautiful: best non-English language entry, 2019

TOOLS AND SKILLS

Design	Product and interaction design, information architecture, design systems, typography, data visualization, art direction
Code	JavaScript, Svelte, React, Node.js, Python, SQL, APIs, ERP integration, AI-assisted workflows
Leadership	Multidisciplinary teams since 2000, redesigns, business cases, training

EDUCATION

- MBA, Trevisan Escola de Negócios, 2022
- Bachelor in Industrial Design, ESDI/UERJ, 1992 – 1996
- Master's coursework in Communication, PUC-SP, 2012 – 2013 (not completed)

LANGUAGES

Portuguese (native), English, and Spanish